



FREE RESOURCE · GUIDE 5 OF 5

Essay 4: Career Plan and Impact

Building a medium- and long-term impact plan that is specific, measurable and genuinely tied to what Chevening supplies.

ABOUT THE EXAMPLES.

All names, institutions, programmes and statistics below are anonymised and reinvented versions of successful essays, changed to show technique. Yours must be real.

THE LIVE QUESTION.

Outline your medium and long-term career plans. Please relate your answer to a key challenge or priority facing your country.

- What impact do you intend to make in your home country?
- How does your career plan connect with your course of study and the challenge or priority you identified?
- What barriers or obstacles might you face, and how will you overcome them?
- How will being a Chevening Scholar help you achieve your ambitions?

WORD LIMIT:

Minimum 100 / Maximum 300 words.

WORD PLAN AT 300 WORDS

Impact intent 60 · Medium term 70 · Long term 70 · Barriers 55 · Chevening 45

IMPORTANT.

Your first year back belongs in Essay 3. Do not repeat it here.

Part one: four rules

1. Capabilities, not job titles.

Describe what you will build or the function you will create, not the title you hope to hold.

2. Ambition is fine; a missing route is fatal.

For every goal, answer “through what?” (institution, partner, evidence, committee, budget line).

3. Show altitude increasing.

Medium term = institutional influence. Long term = system-level change.

4. Name real organisations.

Ministry, directorate, regulator, agency, named national plan, named UK counterpart.

Part two: naming

Name the institution you will join or build inside, the delivery partners (let at least one recur from Essays 1 or 2), the national strategy by its title, the UK counterpart institution, and give the long term a date (e.g. By 2035).

Part three: writing it, paragraph by paragraph

Paragraph 1 — Impact in home country (~60 words)

Name the challenge as a challenge (not a topic). Anchor it to a named national plan or priority. Exact figure.

Paragraph 2 — Medium term (3–5 years) (~70 words)

Capability + institutional door + named partner + measurement instrument. Explicitly link to the course ("using the evaluation design taught on the course").

Paragraph 3 — Long term (8–10 years) (~70 words)

Systems-level: the institution or framework that outlives you. Dated + checkable metric.

Paragraph 4 — Barriers and how you will overcome them (~55 words)

Full sequence: barrier → strategy → resource/partnership → expected outcome.

Include one structural barrier and one about your own standing. Resolve the personal one into Chevening.

Paragraph 5 — How Chevening helps (~45 words)

Name the specific mechanism (alumni fund, named UK institution, access, particular alumni group) and what you will do with it. What becomes impossible or much slower without Chevening?

Part four: two full sample answers

All names, places and statistics are anonymised and reinvented. Do not copy.

Sample one — civil registration (299 words)

Fewer than half the children in Katiba Province hold a birth certificate, and the National Development Plan's commitment to universal registration by 2030 has no monitoring function behind it. Nobody in the National Civil Registration Authority can say which districts are failing which groups. Building that capability is what I intend to spend my career on.

In the medium term, three to five years, I will move from the Institute for Public Administration into the Authority and build its first evaluation unit. Using the evaluation design taught on my course, I will run a matched-comparison study of the notification protocol across four provinces with the Katiba Midwives' Association as delivery partner, and publish the first cost-per-registration figure the Authority has ever held.

By 2035 I want that unit running quarterly national monitoring, disaggregated by district, sex and disability finely enough that failures cannot be averaged away, and feeding directly into the Authority's budget allocation rather than sitting in an annual report.

The obstacle is incentives. District registrars are assessed on volume rather than coverage, so disaggregated data makes them look worse, and reform proposals from practitioners rather than economists are routinely dismissed in our ministry as anecdotal. I will pair the monitoring with a revised performance measure agreed with the Authority's HR directorate, and I will meet the second problem with a matched-comparison study, the Ashcombe Centre as a named research partner, and the credibility the scholarship carries into rooms where I currently have none.

The UK's General Register Office made this transition decades ago and documented every failure on the way. I intend to use that contact and the alumni network to learn its design directly, and to apply to the Chevening alumni fund to extend Kalima into Molo.

Sample two — health security (298 words)

Antimicrobial resistance is treated in my country as a hospital problem, but 70 per cent of antibiotic volume moves through agriculture, where there is no surveillance at all. The National Action Plan on AMR commits to farm-level monitoring and has never had anyone able to build it. That is the gap I intend to fill, and it sits inside a shared UK priority in health security.

In the medium term, three to five years, I will move from the National Reference Laboratory into the AMR Coordination Unit and build the first farm-level surveillance pilot across Katiba and Molo. Success is a sentinel network of 40 poultry farms reporting quarterly, validated against laboratory isolates, and a published baseline that does not currently exist. I will build it with the Veterinary Services Directorate and the Poultry Producers' Association, using the epidemiological modelling taught on my course.

By 2036 I want that network to be a permanent national One Health surveillance system covering poultry, dairy and aquaculture, feeding the annual prescribing guidance. That is the point at which we can show whether resistance in food-producing animals is falling, and act when it is not.

The obstacles are real. Farmers have no incentive to report, and the Veterinary Services Directorate and the Ministry of Health hold separate mandates and budgets. I will make reporting worth doing by returning free susceptibility testing to participating farms, and I will use the Action Plan's existing joint committee as the institutional home rather than building a rival one.

Chevening matters here for access. The UK Veterinary Medicines Directorate runs one of the longest-standing integrated surveillance systems in this field, and I intend to use the alumni network and that contact to learn its design directly rather than reinvent it.

Part five: dos and don'ts

Do

- Name a specific challenge with an exact figure
- Anchor it to a named national plan
- Describe capabilities and institutions, not job titles
- Name the institutional door and a recurring partner
- Give medium term a target + measurement
- Give long term a date + checkable metric
- Include one barrier about your own standing and resolve it into Chevening
- Name a concrete Chevening mechanism

Don't

- Promise a job title on a timetable
 - Say "there will be challenges but I am determined"
 - Repeat Essay 3's first-year plan
 - Write "an international organisation"
 - Aim so low that a decade produces no growth
 - Invent indicators
-
-

Part six: checklist

While drafting

- ☐ Named challenge + exact figure + national plan
- ☐ Medium term: capability + door + partner + measurement + course link
- ☐ Long term: institutional, dated, checkable
- ☐ One structural barrier + one personal standing barrier
- ☐ Each barrier run through strategy → resource → outcome
- ☐ Specific Chevening mechanism named

Before submitting

- ☐ All four live sub-questions visibly answered
- ☐ Course link explicit

- ☐ No repetition of Essay 3 first-year plan
- ☐ At least one partner recurs from Essays 1 or 2
- ☐ Altitude higher than Essay 1
- ☐ Something becomes impossible or much slower without Chevening
- ☐ Within 100–300 words



THE APPLICATION LAB

Want a second pair of eyes on your Chevening essays?

Everything in this guide is easier to see in someone else's draft than your own.

TAL mentors have won or shortlisted for Chevening and other major scholarships, and the community is free to join.

APPLY FOR MENTORSHIP

Apply Now →

1:1 mentor matched to your programme

DISCOVERY CALL

Book a Free Call →

20 minutes with the TAL team

FREE COMMUNITY

Join on WhatsApp →

Free to join, no commitment

LinkedIn /theapplicationlab

Instagram @theapplicationlab

YouTube @TheApplicationLab

All names, institutions, universities, professors, statistics and organisations used as examples in this guide are invented for illustration only. In your own application every name must be real, accurate and defensible at interview. © 2026 The Application Lab · Edspire Labs Ltd · This resource is free to share in its original, unedited form and is not for resale.